# Holden Holden Sandman (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/2

## AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Holden | Model: Holden Sandman | Australian Market Years: 1974-1980
Vehicle Type: Panel Van / Coupe Utility | Segment: Commercial / Lifestyle Sports | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Elizabeth, South Australia, Dandenong, Victoria, Pagewood, New South Wales, Acacia

## 1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Holden Sandman is the undisputed emblem of 1970s Australian youth and beach culture. Introd
uced in January 1974 on the HQ series (option package XX7 / XU3), the Sandman transformed humbl
e commercial panel vans and utilities into vibrant, psychedelic recreational machines. Featurin
g bold side stripes, Monaro GTS sports dashboard with tachometer, GTS steering wheel, slotted s
teel rally wheels, twin bucket seats, and standard or optional 253ci and 308ci Red V8 power, th
e Sandman became a pop-culture legend closely tied to surfing, drive-in cinemas, and Australian
freedom. The Sandman package carried through the HQ, HJ, HX, and HZ series until 1980, with au
thentic surviving examples now among Australia's most fiercely sought-after collector cars.

Originally devised to counter the Ford Falcon Sundowner and Chrysler Valiant Drifter, the Sandm
an completely captured the youth zeitgeist. While legally classified as commercial vehicles (sa
ving buyers significant sales tax at the time), Sandmans were heavily optioned with sports susp
ensions, dual exhaust systems, customized shag-pile carpets, and tailgate mural art. In 1977, t
he HZ series bestowed Radial Tuned Suspension (RTS), giving the Sandman world-class handling dy
namics.

### SERIES / GENERATION: HQ-HJ (HQ / HJ Sandman) [1974-1976]

Body Styles: 2-door panel van, 2-door coupe utility | ANCAP: None
Inaugural Sandman package (XX7 / XU3) on HQ and HJ. Monaro GTS dash, sports wheels, bucket seat
s, and optional 253ci and 308ci Red V8 engines.

**Engines Offered in Australia:**

- Red-202-Sandman: 3.3L (3310cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 101.0 kW / 263.0 Nm
- Red-253-V8-Sandman: 4.2L (4146cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 138.0 kW / 355.0 Nm
- Red-308-V8-Sandman: 5.0L (5044cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 179.0 kW / 427.0 Nm

**Australian Badges / Trims:**

- Sandman Van: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, Tri-Matic 3-speed automatic, TH400 3-speed a
- Sandman Utility: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, Tri-Matic 3-speed automatic, AUD $3450-$

**Factory Configurations:**

* Sandman Van | Panel Van | Red-253-V8-Sandman | 4-speed manual floor | RWD | 138.0kW/355.0Nm
* Sandman Van | Panel Van | Red-308-V8-Sandman | 4-speed manual floor | RWD | 179.0kW/427.0Nm

### SERIES / GENERATION: HX-HZ (HX / HZ Sandman) [1976-1980]

Body Styles: 2-door panel van, 2-door coupe utility | ANCAP: None
Large 'SANDMAN' tailgate script on HX, followed by landmark HZ introduction of Radial Tuned Sus
pension (RTS), front chin spoiler, and 4-wheel disc brake option.

**Engines Offered in Australia:**

- Red-4.2-V8-ADR27A: 4.2L (4146cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 120.0 kW / 325.0 Nm
- Red-5.0-V8-ADR27A: 5.0L (5044cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 161.0 kW / 400.0 Nm

**Australian Badges / Trims:**

- Sandman Van (HZ): Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, Tri-Matic 3-speed automatic, TH400 3-sp

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### Factory Configurations:

* Sandman Van (HZ) | Panel Van | Red-5.0-V8-ADR27A | 4-speed manual floor | RWD | 161.0kW/400.0Nm